Patrick Skeels

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Employment

2025- Lecturer, University of Kentucky
2024 Lecturer, UC Davis
2023 Assistant Professor of Philosophy, Cosumnes River College
2022 Adjunct Professor of Philosophy, Cosumnes River College

Education

2016-2023 PhD in Philosophy, UC Davis
Dissertation: "The Dynamics of Disagreement and Contradiction"
Supervisor: Adam Sennet
Committee: Rohan French, Hanti Lin, Masoud Jasbi, Justin Khoo

2019-2023 MA in Linguistics, UC Davis
Thesis: "The Prospects for Cloudy Contextualism"
Supervisor: Masoud Jasbi

2013-2016 MA in Philosophy, San Francisco State University
Thesis: "Definite Descriptions in a 2D Semantics for Epistemic Modals"
Supervisors: Bas van Fraassen, Carlos Montemayor

2005-2010 BA in Philosophy, UC Davis

Areas of specialization

Philosophy of Language • Epistemology • Philosophical Logic • Philosophy of Science

Areas of competence

Ethics • Metaethics • Philosophy of Mathematics • Philosophy of Addiction • Modern Philosophy

Publications & talks

Journal articles

Forthcoming "There Can Be No Dispute." *Philosophical Studies.*
"Context, Consistency, and Non-Contradiction." *Australasian Journal of Philosophy.*
2026 "Dynamic 'Might' and Correct Belief." *Inquiry: An Interdisciplinary Journal of Philosophy*, vol. 69(2), 1139-1184.

https://www.tandfonline.com/doi/abs/10.1080/0020174X.2023.2249946

2020 "A Tale of Two Nortons." *Studies in History and Philosophy of Science*, Part A. vol. 83, 28–35. https://www.sciencedirect.com/science/article/abs/pii/S0039368119300780

Refereed Presentations

2026 "Testing for Coherence" Debating Dynamic Semantics at The Saul Kripke Center, City University New York
"There can be no Dispute" Kentucky Philosophical Association at Northern Kentucky University
"There can be no Dispute" Eastern APA
2025 "There can be no Dispute" Annual Meeting of the Illinois Philosophical Association at Eastern Illinois University
2022 "What we Might Disagree About" PHiGS Graduate Colloquium† at The University of Kent
"What we Might Disagree About" Eighth Annual Symposium on Language Research at UC Davis
"What we Might Disagree About" California Universities Semantics and Pragmatics (CUSP) at UCLA
2021 "Dynamic 'Might' and Correct Belief" Agreement and Disagreement Beyond Ethics and Epistemology Conference† at The University of Kent
2020 "The Dynamics of Disagreement" Pacific APA (*Cancelled due to Covid-19*)
"The Dynamics of Disagreement" The Wisdom and Madness of Crowds: Argumentation, Information Exchange and Social Interaction† at The ILLC
"Epistemic Modals, Inconsistency, and Disagreement" 12th Annual Meeting of the Illinois Language and Linguistics Society at UI Urbana-Champagne
2018 "A Tale of Two Nortons" Illinois Philosophical Association at Eastern Illinois University
"A Tale of Two Nortons" Western Michigan University Graduate Philosophy Conference
"A Tale of Two Nortons" UI Urbana Champagne Philosophy Graduate Conference

Invited Presentations

2026 "Denial, Affirmation, and Disagreement" L^3Lab at UC Davis
2023 "Context, Consistency, and Contradiction" Chico State Philosophy Colloquium

Comments

2025 "Dodging the Question: Non-Solutions to Benardete Paradoxes" by Adam DeDobbelaere. Illinois Philosophical Association at Eastern Illinois University
"Generic Guidance" by Bernhard Nickel. Central APA†
2019 "The Intimating Power of Art in Theodor Adorno's Aesthetic Theory" by Shamoni Sarkar. Berkeley-Stanford-Davis Philosophy Conference
2018 "Information Sensitive Deontic Modals" by Joe Glover. Illinois Philosophical Association at Eastern Illinois University
2017 "A New Way out of The Preface Paradox" by Wooram Lee. Berkeley-Stanford-Davis Philosophy Conference

† = online

Grants, honors & awards

2022 Dean's Summer Fellowship, UC Davis
'Hume in the 21st Century: Perpetuating the Enlightenment' Summer Institute Stipend, National Endowment of the Humanities
2020 Graduate Student Travel Grant, American Philosophical Association
2017 Fellowship Award, UC Davis Department of Philosophy

Teaching

University of Kentucky

Phi120- The Art of Thinking: An Introduction to Logic ×2
Phi320- Symbolic Logic I ×1
Phi130- Introduction to Philosophy: Morality and Society ×5
Phi330- Ethics ×2
Phi334H- Honors Business Ethics ×1
Phi334- Business Ethics ×4

UC Davis

Phi012- Introduction to Symbolic Logic ×4
Phi13g - Minds, Brains, and Computers ×1
Phi015 - Introduction to Bioethics ×1
Phi112 - Intermediate Symbolic Logic ×3
Phi121 - Bioethics ×1

Cosumnes River College

Phi300 - Introduction to Philosophy ×7
Phi320 - Introduction to Logic and Critical Thinking ×1

San Francisco State University

Phi101 - Introduction to Philosophy ×1
Phi110 - Introduction to Critical Thinking ×3

Non-College Teaching

Johns Hopkins Center for Talented Youth- Critical Thinking
Johns Hopkins Center for Talented Youth - Introduction to Logic

Service to the profession

2026- Kentucky Philosophical Association President (KPA)
2026- Kentucky Analytic Philosophy workShop (KAPS) Founder/Organizer

2025-	UK Philosophy Mentor Program Founder/Organizer
2025-	UK Philosophy Club Faculty Mentor
2021	UC Davis Directed Reading Program in Mathematics Mentor
2020-2024	UC Davis L^3 Language Lab member
2020-2022	Davis EXchange (DEX) Conference Co-organizer
2018-2022	LLEMMMA Reading Group Organizer
2017-2023	UC Davis Graduate Student Mentor
2017-2022	Berkeley-Stanford-Davis Graduate Conference Referee
2017-2022	Berkeley-Stanford-Davis Graduate Conference Organizer
2014-2016	SFSU Philosophy Mentor Program Organizer
2013-2016	SFSU Philosophy Mentor
2014-2016	SFSU Reading Group in Logic and Formal Philosophy Co-founder/Co-organizer